

Richmond Regional Heirs' Property Study



Locality Fact Sheet: Petersburg

Analysis by HDAvisors in support of the [Richmond Heirs Property Network](#), 2026.

This sheet summarizes the heirs' property indicators found across Petersburg's parcels, read from public records. The result is a regional screen identifying parcels with an elevated risk of being an heirs' property, not a legal determination of title. The numbers below show how many parcels were flagged, how they compare to the rest of the local parcel stock, and where in Petersburg they cluster.

FLAGGED PARCELS

729

of 14,933 parcels

SHARE OF PARCEL STOCK

4.88%

study area 2.12%

CONFIDENCE TIERS

194 / 535

high confidence / likely

CLUSTER TRACTS

9 hot / 0 cold

of 11 census tracts

Flagged Parcels vs. All Parcel Stock

Petersburg

	FLAGGED	ALL STOCK
Median assessed value	\$72,100	\$95,600
Median build year	1956	1957
USPS vacancy, known status	23.11%	5.68%

Study Area for Comparison

8,091 flagged of 381,852 parcels

	FLAGGED	ALL STOCK
Median assessed value	\$245,700	\$329,000
Median build year	1965	1981
USPS vacancy, known status	9.55%	1.03%

Ownership Signals

Share of flagged parcels carrying each signal

Explicit estate language		3.2%
Deceased owner of record		77.2%
Long tenure		68.7%
Absentee owner		63.6%
Out-of-state owner		11.8%

Selected signals are shown. Parcels can carry more than one signal, so percentages do not sum to 100%.

Property Type Mix

Share of flagged parcels by type

Occupied family home		60.8%
Multi-owner absentee home		6.7%
Empty lot		11.9%
Vacant house		20.6%

Vacancy is the share of parcels with a known USPS vacancy status. Parcels with no status on record are excluded from the denominator.

Property types are groupings of statistically similar parcels. No single trait defines membership.

Hot- and cold-cluster tracts have flagged-parcel rates statistically above or below the regional pattern. Tracts with fewer than 5 heirs-flagged parcels or fewer than 100 total parcels are not assigned a rate class. 0 of 11 tracts here are below that threshold.

High confidence indicates stronger, converging heirs' property evidence. Likely indicates meaningful but less conclusive evidence. Both are classifications, not legal determinations of heirs' property status.

Data Sources: ReGrid parcel records, Q1 2026; U.S. Census Bureau, "2024 ACS 5-Year Estimates Detailed Tables," 2024, <https://api.census.gov/data/2024/acs/acs5>, accessed June 9 2026.

How Petersburg Differs from the Study Area

Share of flagged parcels

	PETERSBURG	STUDY AREA
Deceased owner of record	77.2%	81.7%
Absentee owner	63.6%	45.7%
Occupied family home	60.8%	69.4%
Vacant house	20.6%	8.6%

USPS vacancy is much more common among Petersburg’s flagged parcels than across the city’s parcel stock.	23.11% Flagged	5.68% All stock
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Petersburg’s 1937 Residential Categories

Current flagged parcel rates range from 3.8% in areas labeled Best Residential to 5.8% in areas labeled Colored Residential.

Best Residential 45 of 1,162 parcels flagged		3.87%
Poor White Residential 34 of 850 parcels flagged		4.0%
Mixed Colored and White 15 of 354 parcels flagged		4.24%
Fair Residential 248 of 5,297 parcels flagged		4.68%
Colored Residential 205 of 3,519 parcels flagged		5.83%

Petersburg’s categories describe race, class, and land use rather than forming an A-to-D grade sequence. They are ordered here by current flagged-parcel rate.

Assessed Property Value

Petersburg’s 729 flagged parcels represent a substantial amount of assessed property value across homes, lots, and ownership interests.

TOTAL ASSESSED VALUE

\$61.4M

across 727 flagged parcels with positive values

MEDIAN ASSESSED VALUE

\$72,100

among Petersburg’s flagged parcels

Nelson, R. K., Winling, L., et al. (2023). *Mapping Inequality: Redlining in New Deal America*. Digital Scholarship Lab. <https://dsl.richmond.edu/panorama/redlining/>
The five residential categories shown contain 547 of Petersburg’s 729 flagged parcels, or 75%. All categories within the 1937 map contain 567, or 78%. Business, Parks and Cemeteries, and Industrial are excluded from the comparison; Industrial contains fewer than five flagged parcels.
Total assessed value accounts for multi-lot parcel groups and includes parcels with positive assessed values. Assessed value is not market value, homeowner equity, or value lost.
The Study Area includes Richmond City, Petersburg, Hopewell, Colonial Heights, Chesterfield County, and Henrico County. Comparisons use the 8,091 flagged parcels across the Study Area. Vacancy rates are calculated only among parcels with a known USPS vacancy status.